Activity logs

Another crucial thing to have in all applications is an activity or audit log. This means you log everything in your application. For example, if a user updates a product's price you create records such as this:

id	subject_type	subject_id	event	old_data	new_data
1	App\Models\Product	1	updated	{"id": 1, "price": 1900}	{"id": 1, "price": 2900}

So you log every change in the application including these events:

- Create
- Update
- Delete

This way you have the complete history of your application in one table that can be used for mainly debugging.

Fortunately, Spatie (as always) has an excellent package called laravel-activitylog. After you've installed the package, you can configure it in the `config/activitylog.php` config file:

```
return [
  'delete_records_older_than_days' => 365,

  'default_log_name' => 'default',

  'activity_model' => \Spatie\Activitylog\Models\Activity::class,

  'table_name' => 'activity_log',

  'database_connection' => env('ACTIVITY_LOGGER_DB_CONNECTION'),
];
```

These are some of the most important configs. By default, it uses the `activity_log` table and the same connection as your application. If you want you can have a separate activity log database.

To enable it on a model, all we need to do is this: